Remembering the Future

Appraisal of Records and the Role of Archives in Constructing Social Memory

Terry Cook

Appraisal occurs primarily today on the records of yesterday to create a past for tomorrow. What kind of past should the future have? This essay represents in part a narrative about archival appraisal, that function that selects for long-term preservation as society's memory roughly 1-5 percent of the total documentation of major institutions and considerably less from private citizens. In keeping with the internationalism of these seminars, which featured voices from many countries, this essay is perhaps more a postmodern story from Canada than an exposition of appraisal strategy and criteria or a detailed critique of various other narratives (schools of thought?) about appraisal.

Appraisal imposes a heavy social responsibility on archivists. As they appraise records, they are doing nothing less than shaping the future of our documentary heritage. They are determining what the future will know about its past, which is often our present. As a profession, we archivists need to realize continually the gravity of this task. We are literally creating archives. We are deciding what is remembered and what is forgotten, who in society is visible and who remains invisible, who has a voice and who does not. In this act of creation, we must remain extraordinarily sensitive to the political and philosophical nature of documents individually, of archives collectively, of archival functions, of archivists' personal biases, and especially of archival appraisal. That process defines the creators, functions, and activities to be included in archives by selecting which documents become archives and thus enjoy all subsequent archival processes (description, conservation, exhibition, reference, and so on) and, just as starkly and with finality, which documents are destroyed, excluded from archives, forgotten from memory.

Appraisal is thus central to the archival endeavor—indeed, it is the *only* archival endeavor, a continuing activity without end, the heart of archives. And it is controversial. Pioneering archivists and some writers still believe that appraisal is unarchival, wrenching records from their original context of creation. For the majority of archivists, who recognize the necessity of selecting some part from an unmanageable whole, differences abound on the principles or concepts (or theories) that should animate appraisal or that define the “value” or “significance” or “importance” of records—all terms used in archival legislation and by archivists, usually without definition or reflection. “What makes the good?” the Greeks long ago asked. What makes something have value, be worth preserving and remembering? Not surprisingly, without clear first principles, the resulting strategies and methodologies have achieved no consensus.

Both parts of this essay's title, “Remembering the Future: Appraisal of Records and the Role of Archives in Constructing Social Memory,” might alarm, even frighten, many archivists and indeed historians and other users of archives. Both halves are contrary to archival orthodoxy. Both clash with the stereotype of the archivist's widely accepted role in society. Archivists remember the past, not the future. They deal with history, not current or future events. They do not construct social memory—that is the role of historians and other users of the archive who, through their works, create the stories and Page 170 → narratives, the myths and memories, that underpin our collective identities. Archivists are rather a kind of invisible bridge, or honest broker, between creators and users of records. Archivists are guardians of the past, not its interpreters. Archivists are in the preservation business, not the memory one.

Indeed, until the 1980s, archivists, at least in Canada, often described themselves—proudly—as “the handmaidens of historians.” In retrospect, that phrase is astonishing for its servility and its gender connotations. Until recently, women remained largely invisible in social and historical memory, relegated as the silent and usually unrecognized supporters of male accomplishment; so too, archivists have remained invisible in the construction of

social memory, their role also poorly articulated and rarely appreciated. I might go further and say that just as patriarchy required women to be the subservient, invisible handmaidens to male power, historians and other users of archives require archivists to be neutral, invisible, silent handmaidens of historical research.[1] I will return to this point later in the essay.

My message is simple. Archivist are active agents in constructing social and historical memory. In so doing, they have an obligation to remember or consider the needs and expectations of the future as much as to conserve or remember the past. Furthermore, in so doing, archivists must reflect society's "values" rather than those of prominent sponsors or traditional users and must leave a transparent account of the reasons why keep/ destroy decisions were made. And historians and other users of archives need to engage in this archival process rather than deny it, as has heretofore largely been the case.

My approach here (and to appraisal) is consciously postmodern. My colleague at the University of Manitoba, Tom Nesmith, has written that especially for those of us inheriting the British empirical tradition,

> one of the key things that Western philosophy has sought to marginalize or "efface" is the "sign" or means of communication. . . . [T]his indicates a desire for "pure presence without representation" or a clear understanding of reality without much consideration of the effects of communication processes on what we know. . . . This effacement of the sign has made archives a "ghost" or all but invisible in the knowledge creation process, and thus society.[2]

Along this same line, Patrick Geary, a historian of medieval European memory and a previous participant in these seminars, labels as "Phantoms of Remembrance" those scribes and clerics who helped to shape the medieval record through their little-noticed archival activities, ensuring thereby "memory and oblivion" for the events and figures of their times.[3] Concerning such translucent "ghosts" of archives, Jacques Derrida counsels that we must recognize and learn how to live "with the ghost . . . how to talk with him, with her, how to let them speak or how to give them back speech." To make the invisible visible once more, to make the inarticulate articulate, "we must speak," Derrida says, "to the ghost."[4] So, especially in archival appraisal, we take a journey with these archival memory phantoms.

Let me expand a little (in I hope a not irrelevant aside) my assertion that archivists remain shadowy ghosts to most historians and other users. Scholars are just lately beginning to see that notions of the objective or "invisible" archive were reinforced by nineteenth-century historians undertaking what they assumed (hoped?) was objective, scientific history in the von Rankean mode. By definition, that required in turn a neutral, impartial, objective, "natural" archives. Yet this blindness toward the ghosts of archives (or their invisibility) continues well past the often-shared origins of the two professions in the 1800s.

In the past decade or so, a tremendous outpouring of historical writing has concerned memory, how societies chose to commemorate the past, the institutions and symbols that individuals and groups create to reinforce their identity, power, and status in the present. These works range from analyses of historic sites to war memorials, from plaques and markers to public commemorations and holidays, from theater, music, and films to cemeteries, antiques, preserved ruins, even Disneylands and similar pieces of organized nostalgia and heritage tourism. And with rare exceptions, these authors all have one thing in common: they are silent about the role of archives as memory institutions or the function of archives and archiving in society—despite the fact that national, state, and local archives were being created and then defined and shaped at the same time as many of the institutions and movements and celebrations about which such historians write. (The shining exception to this rule are the medievalists, including Michael Clanchy, Patrick Geary, and Jacques Le Goff.) We have a growing shelf of books by historians that analyze the founding, evolution, and animating values of nineteenth- and twentieth-century museums, art galleries, and libraries, even zoos—all institutions engaged in and reflecting the social constructions of cultural memory. Yet as of the turn of this century, Page 171 → no books did the same for archives. Invisible ghosts indeed. In the wake of Derrida's landmark volume (published in English in 1996), this has finally begun to change—as these Sawyer Seminars witness—at the level of journal literature and conference papers. Why?

There is more to this invisibility, this ghostly archive, surely, than mere oversight or historians' kindly trust that archivists go about their business in a responsible way. My former National Archives colleague, Brien Brothman, asserts that historians are collectively—if maybe subconsciously—afraid to venture into this area. This exclusion of archives from historians' consciousness—archives as process and as institution and as records—is, Brothman believes, “a peculiar form of disciplinary repression or blindness.”

Symptomatic of this blindness is historians' relegation of discussion of archival sources to the margins—to introductions, prefaces, postscripts, or footnotes or endnotes—rather than the integration of them into the text, as is the convention in almost every other social science discipline. Brothman wonders if this may in fact be a “blindness of insight,” an unconscious recognition by historians that “the distancing, the spacing, between archives and history” is essential to the “empowering” traditional discourses of both professions. Without this distance, he continues, “the differentiation between the archival object (the record or document, the artefact) and the historical object (the book, the article, knowledge [of the past]) begins to break down; archives and history begin to transgress each other, pollute each other.” He notes that Canadian historian Susan Mann has mused, in reviewing A. S Byatt's *Possession*, that “the traditional distinctions between fact and fiction, literature and history had become ‘decidedly blurred.’” She might have added, between archives and history and myth and reality. This blurring frightens both professions as they have traditionally been defined—history working on the edges of archives, archives working on the edges of history, each threatened, if moving too closely together, in Brothman's phrase, by canceling “out the purity of each other's intentions, each other's object[ivity].” That assumes the traditional view for both professions that objectivity is possible.[5]

Brothman's insights seem to be borne out inadvertently by the major scholar on that question, Peter Novick. In his influential book, *That Noble Dream: The “Objectivity Question” and the American Historical Profession*, Novick manages, over 629 pages of text, not to mention the role or impact of archives or of the archival choosing and subsequent (re)arrangement and description of historians' source material as having any influence whatsoever on the question of objectivity.[6] Perhaps if for historians the archive needs to be natural, objective, neutral, invisible, in terms of its holdings, then the whole question of how the stuff actually gets in the archive must surely be beyond the pale. A leading Canadian historian, Joy Parr, graphically illustrates this point. In a reflective essay in the *Canadian Historical Review*, she cautions historians that historical interpretation begins not when they write their texts but long before, when they open boxes in archival reading rooms.[7] In those archival boxes, historians choose to read only certain files, to scan only certain images or posters or maps, to focus only on certain authors or groups or regions, to take notes regarding or to photocopy only certain documents. Historians then impose on these chosen, privileged documents a further limitation of a particular narrative and interpretative framework. Actually, the picture is considerably more stark than Parr paints. The major act of historical interpretation occurs not when historians open boxes but when archivists fill the boxes, by implication destroying the 98 percent of records that do not make it into those or any other archival boxes. This is the great silence between archivists and historians. It is called archival appraisal.

In terms of archives and the future—the “remembering the future” part of my title—let me cite the well-known words of Canadian National Archivist Sir Arthur Doughty, who said in 1924, in a phrase that appears on posters and mugs found in many Canadian archivists' offices as well as on the base of the only statue ever raised officially in Ottawa to honor a civil servant, “Of all national assets, archives are the most precious. They are the gift of one generation to another, and the extent of our care of them marks the extent of our civilization.”[8] I focus less on Doughty's archival “assets”—the actual records that form the foundation of American or Canadian studies in a multitude of disciplines—than on Doughty's notion of “care” and his concept of archives as a “gift” to the future. What do archivists do to records—how do they “care” for them, and, perhaps most importantly, how do they choose which archives to place under such “care”? How do they fill Parr's boxes that historians encounter in the reading rooms of a nation's archives? What knowledge and skills are required to do this? What is the collective nature of this “gift” of memory communicated across generations with various technologies? How does the present choose the past by which the future will “know itself”? And in so doing, has Canada developed approaches that are Page 172 → distinctive and perhaps informative to those who practice archiving elsewhere?

Another Canadian national archivist and past president of the International Council of Archives, Jean-Pierre

Wallot, has set the inspiring goal for archivists of “building a living memory for the history of our present.” The resulting “houses of memory,” in his words, will contain the “keys to the collective memory” that the world's citizens can use to open doors to the personal and societal well-being that comes from experiencing continuity with the past, from a sense of roots, of belonging, of forming various identities.[9] In the rootlessness of the wired global community, in the mobility that undermines extended families and oral traditions, where the speed of life makes yesterday recede quickly into the distant past and tomorrow approaches with so much uncertainty, French historian Pierre Nora responds by asserting that “modern memory is, above all, archival. It relies entirely on the materiality of the trace, the immediacy of the recording, the visibility of the image.”[10]

Here there are clear resonances with Marshall McLuhan's and especially Harold Innis's pioneering Canadian work on the history and theory of communications technology from the late 1940s to the late 1960s—long before the postmodern revolution arrived in the English-speaking world. In a long series of historical works, Innis demonstrated the importance of recording media and the technologies of communication in forming and maintaining empires, all of them based on monopolies of knowledge, that allowed for the exercise of power over space and time. All such media have built-in biases in their communication, Innis asserted, leading to his famous student Marshall McLuhan's aphorism that the “medium is the message.”[11] Archives are the material traces of just such media, the concrete fragments that form our memories, the way we conquer time across generations, as Doughty said, the way our society legitimizes and memorializes itself, the way we influence the future by shaping the past. What then, in Innis's phrase, are the “biases” of archives as a collective communication medium between the past and the future?

To address if not definitively answer these questions, I will explore the Canadian archival voice, especially in appraisal, and its broader ramifications for international archiving, but I first will discuss archivists' traditional thinking about archives—probably the views held by most users of archives if they were to think consciously about the institutions in which they do their research. I will then look at radically new formulations about archives—what might be called the “postmodern archive”—and suggest why Canada has taken a lead in its articulation, especially in appraisal. I will then briefly conclude by suggesting that Canadian distinctiveness in this area has global significance in our new century of networked communications, where the realization of McLuhan's “global village” threatens to homogenize all distinctiveness into a universal blandness.

Traditional archival theory and professional practice was first articulated in nineteenth-century Europe, after centuries of informal development, and then was exported around the world, including to the United States, Canada, Australia, and South Africa.[12] This development paralleled the emergence of history as a university-based discipline and profession. Most of the early professional archivists were trained as historians at such universities.

Just as much of the early professional history focused on the political, legal, and economic character of the nation-state, so too were the first articulations of archival principles strongly biased in favor of the state. Almost all the classic tomes about archival methodology were written by staff members of national archives. Not surprisingly, most focused on government, public, or corporate records and their orderly transfer to archival repositories to preserve their original order and classification, and most relegated private and personal archives to the purview of libraries and librarians. Indeed, to this day, archives in Europe generally look after only the official records of their sponsoring governments, while national or regional or university libraries take custody of personal manuscripts. That tradition remains strong in most other English-speaking countries, although not in Canada.

Moreover, these early archival writers lived in an era of document scarcity, where their experience was based on dealing with limited numbers of medieval documents susceptible to careful diplomatic analysis of each page or with records found in well-organized departmental registry systems of the emerging modern nation-state, existing within stable, centralized administrations exhibiting classic Weberian hierarchical structures. Most completely ignored the appraisal and selection of modern archives as these terms are now understood; indeed, such activity by archivists was strongly discouraged as “unarchival.” Clearly influenced by Darwinian thinking and metaphors, the pre-1930 archival pioneer thinkers asserted that records coming to archives from state departments were a kind of natural, organic residue left over from administrative processes. Archivists then kept this residue in pristine order

in the archival building. Indeed, Page 173 → archivists in Britain were called “keepers,” reflecting that earlier mind-set.

State officials rather than archivists would therefore decide which records would survive by a process of natural winnowing the wheat from the chaff according to administrative and political needs. The records themselves were viewed as value-free vessels reflecting the acts and facts that caused them to be created. Archivists kept the records, in the words of one early theorist, “without prejudice or afterthought” and were thus viewed—indeed, extolled—as impartial, neutral, objective custodians. A pioneering writer with enormous influence even asserted that the archivist is “the most selfless devotee of Truth the modern world produces.” And notice it is *Truth* with a capital *T*.[13]

Such traditional approaches sanctioned archives' and archivists' already strong predilection, as state institutions and employees, to support mainstream culture and powerful records creators. Such approaches privilege the official narratives of the state over the documented stories of individuals and groups in society or, indeed, their interaction with and influence on the state. The rules for evidence and authenticity so adopted favor the textual documents from which such rules were derived at the expense of other media for experiencing the present and thus of viewing the past. The positivist and “scientific” values permeating such thinking prevented archivists then and since from adopting and then documenting multiple ways of seeing and knowing. Archivists seek or reimpose an original order rather than allowing for several orders or even disorders to exist among records and thus in their descriptions. Researchers are instead presented with a well-organized, rationalized, monolithic view of a record collection that may never have existed that way in operational reality. And this traditional view seriously hobbles archivists trying to cope with the new technology of electronic records, where archivists' active intervention up front in the processes of record creation rather than passive receipt of records long thereafter is the only hope that today's computer-based history can be written tomorrow. Moreover, the volumes of modern paper records and the electronic record require the archivist to appraise records to choose the typically 1 or 2 percent that will be designated as archival; this active construction of select fragments of the past into social memory is of course completely at odds with the earlier notion of archivists as passive keepers of an entire body or residue of records handed over by their creator. An even greater absence of order or system is apparent in the record-keeping habits of private individuals and organizations.

In addition to these alterations in recording technologies, a marked change has occurred over recent decades in the reasons why archival institutions exist—or at least public and publicly funded archives (self-funded private business archives do not share fully in these developments). A collective shift has taken place during the past century from a juridical-administrative justification for archives grounded in concepts of the state to a sociocultural justification for archives grounded in wider public policy and public use. Simply stated, it is no longer acceptable to limit the definition of society's memory solely to the documentary residue left over (or chosen) by powerful record creators, whether Richard Nixon or Oliver North, Soviet commissars or state police in apartheid South Africa, Canadian military officers in Somalia or doctors working with tainted blood products for Health Canada, Queensland politicians or Tokyo Olympic Games organizers. Public and historical accountability demands more of archives and of archivists.[14]

As a result, Canadian archivists working in publicly funded institutions have begun to think in terms of documenting the process of governance, not just of governments governing.[15] “Governance” includes cognizance of the dialogue and interaction of citizens and groups with the state, the impact of the state on society, and the functions or activities of society itself as much as the inner workings of government structures. The archivist in appraisal and all subsequent actions should focus, this argument goes, on the records of governance, not just on records of government, when dealing with institutional records. This perspective also better complements the work of archivists dealing with personal papers or private “manuscript” archives. I will return to this point.

These various changes make archivists active mediators in shaping the collective memory through archives. Because of the need to research and understand the nature of the functional and structural context in which records are created and in which the record-keeping and media-generating processes take place and because of the need to interpret records' relative importance as the basis for modern archival appraisal and description as well as for

making choices for preservation, exhibitions, and Web site construction, the traditional notion of the impartial archivist is no longer acceptable—if it ever was. Archivists inevitably will inject their personal values into all such activities and thus will need to examine very consciously their choices in the archive-creating and memory-formation processes, and they will need to leave very clear records explaining their choices to posterity. The ghosts must become flesh and blood.[16]

In this rethinking of the traditional state-centered and positivist framework for archives, and substituting a distinctively postmodern alternative in the ways I have suggested, Canadian archivists have led the way internationally. I would estimate that at least 75 percent of the world's English-language publications on the postmodern archive have been written by Canadians.[17] Perhaps it is fair to say that the fiercest opposition to the postmodern archive also comes from Canada. This is not surprising because postmodern archivists have repeatedly challenged five central principles of the traditional archival profession.

1. Archivists are neutral, impartial custodians of “Truth,” managing records according to universal, value-free theories.
2. Archives as documents and as institutions are disinterested by-products of actions and administrations.
3. The origin or provenance of records must be found in or assigned to a single office rather than situated in the complex processes and multiple discourses of creation.
4. The order and language imposed on records through archival arrangement and description are value-free re-creations of some prior reality.
5. Archives are (or should be) the passively inherited, natural or organic metanarrative of the state.

Some of these generalizations about postmodern archives are supported by a growing literature on the history of archives as well as the wave of philosophical writing appearing in journals since the late 1990s—as noted earlier, since the publication of Derrida's *Archive Fever*—all showing archives to be extremely problematic as loci for memory. Historians are at last discovering the historicity of the archive. Maybe more archivists will soon follow. The tone of this work is well set by historian Jacques Le Goff, who notes that “the document is not objective, innocent raw material but expresses past society's power over memory and over the future: the document is what remains.” What is true of each document is true of archives collectively. By no coincidence, the first archives were the royal ones of Mesopotamia, Egypt, China, and pre-Columbian America. The capital city in these and later civilizations becomes, in Le Goff's words, “the center of a politics of memory” where “the king himself deploys, on the whole terrain over which he holds sway, a program of remembering of which he is the center.” First the creation and then the control of memory leads to the control of history and thus mythology and ultimately power. Feminist scholar Gerda Lerner also convincingly demonstrates that such power lay be-hind the first documents, the first archives, and the subsequent formation of societal memory and that it was remorselessly and intentionally patriarchal: women were delegitimized by the archival process in the ancient world, a process that continued well into the twentieth century. During the first major event of the French Revolution, the storming of the Bastille and its rural counterparts in 1789, the Parisian mob was not trying—motivated by ideals of liberty, equality, and fraternity—primarily to free prisoners but rather was intent on destroying the king's tax and feudal land records housed in the old fortress to eliminate evidence of outstanding public debt and servitude. Many other examples are now coming to light (more than a few in papers presented at the Sawyer Seminars) of archives collected—and later weeded, reconstructed, even destroyed—not to keep the best juridical evidence of legal and business transactions, as traditionally supposed in archival mythology, but to serve historical and sacral/symbolic purposes for those figures and events judged worthy of celebrating or memorializing within the context of their time.[18] But who is worthy? And who determines worthiness? According to what values? Historical research, in summary, suggests that there is nothing neutral, objective, or “natural” about the process of remembering and forgetting.

Why have Canadian archivists taken this distinctive lead in reconceptualizing the archive? I think the influence of McLuhan and Innis cannot be discounted; their concerns with nonprint media, communications technologies, and the biases they carried in shaping past civilizations as well as our own are insights that were consciously

transported to the world of archives and how records and media shape the past. Hugh Taylor, a disciple of McLuhan and a leading Canadian archivist of the 1970s and 1980s, fundamentally influenced a whole generation of young archivists.[19] I think too that the same generation of now senior archivists trained as historians that is doing this writing in Canada saw, through the study of the history of records, the central French and English dualism of Canada, and its multicultural and First Nations (or aboriginal) layers what the United Nations has declared to be the most ethnically diverse country in the world; thus, these archivists perceived early on the existence of different stories, mixed narratives about and multiple interpretations of similar past events and even the same past texts, that generated doubts about "Truth" and objectivity in recorded memory. Not just history but the recording of it was filled with diversity and ambiguity.

A second contributing factor, complementing the first Page 175 → and in some ways its workplace manifestation, is the "total archive" approach. Canada alone of First World nations has developed at the national level the total archives approach, where almost all public archives in the country—national, provincial, territorial, municipal, university, and regional—acquire as part of their mandate, within one archival institution, a total archive of roughly equal extents of both public, government, or sponsoring institution records and related private-sector records and to take into their archives the total record in every recording medium (including film, television, paintings, and sound recordings, which in many countries are divided among several other repositories). In effect, the separated European and American and Australian public archives and historical manuscript traditions are combined inside one institution. Although there are many reasons why total archives evolved in Canada since the nineteenth century, this integration of the public and private reflects the same wider vision of archives I've just mentioned, one sanctioned in and reflective of society at large, of the total historical human experience, rather than limited to a view of archivists solely as the custodians of official state records.[20] If Canadian philosopher and novelist John Ralston Saul is right that during the 1840s Canada invented the first postmodern nation, respecting diversity, complexity, and a culture of minorities rather than a monolithic national myth, then perhaps it is only natural that Canada has also invented the postmodern archive.[21]

This Canadian approach to archives has manifestations in working reality beyond just the total archives orientation; it is more than an academic exercise in theoretical or postmodern redefinition. And nowhere is this more evident than in new approaches to archival appraisal.

In the early 1990s, the National Archives of Canada developed the concept, strategy, and practice of "macro-appraisal" to select the 1 or 2 percent of government records that have enduring value as archives from among all the documentation created in thousands of information systems in tens of thousands of offices. The National Archives did so within the total archives policy umbrella and postmodern cultural ethos.

Macroappraisal finds sanction for archival "value" of determining what to keep and what to destroy not in the dictates of the state, as is traditional, or in following the latest trends of historical research, as has been more recent practice, but in trying to reflect society's values through a functional analysis of the citizen's interaction with the state. But macroappraisal is about more than just functional analysis, which is what some other countries have mainly drawn from the Canadian model. Macroappraisal focuses on the functions of governance rather than the structures or activities of government per se, emphasizes the interactive functioning of citizen and group as much as that of the state, encompasses all media rather than privileging text, searches for multiple narratives and hot spots of contested discourse rather than accepting the party line, and deliberately seeks to give voice to the marginalized, to the "other," to losers as well as winners, by looking anew at case files especially and electronic data. Then, based on such research analysis, macroappraisal chooses the most succinct record in the best medium for documenting these phenomena. Macroappraisal is especially helpful—essential—for appraising electronic records.

All societies (including the archivists residing in them) assign greater or lesser value to different dimensions of the three-way interplay of social structures, societal functions, and citizens and groups. This interplay is how society functions. And what is important is the process of interplaying rather than the three separate entities per se. And in turn, such value assignment to particular social-functional phenomena will determine, when this insight is transformed into an appraisal model, which related records are declared to be archival or which are not.

Macroappraisal theory posits that archivists may determine such societal values by specifying the generic functional attributes and points of special intersection, conflict, or interplay among the creators of records (that is, structures, agencies, actors); sociohistorical trends and patterns (that is, revealed through functions, programs, activities); and clients, customers, citizens, or groups on whom both function and structure impinge and who in turn influence both, directly or indirectly, explicitly or implicitly. Macroappraisal theory explores the nature of these agents and acts and the interconnections or interrelationships between them and assigns greater importance, or "value," to certain functional-structural factors than to others. This is why it is known as "functional appraisal." Because the functional context of creation and contemporary use determines value, macroappraisal is a provenance-based approach. Because it looks first at functions rather than records, it has been called a "top-down" approach. The fact that appraisal has traditionally focused on the value of records has led this approach, which focuses first on the value of functions, to be called "macroappraisal." To get people thinking—or just to stir up trouble—I have often said of this approach to appraisal value determination that although archivists have traditionally appraised records for eventual use by Page 176 → researchers, archivists should neither appraise records nor try to anticipate their use.[22]

Macroappraisal gives strategic priority to functions and work processes at the top, not to recorded products or records emerging at the bottom from those functions and processes. I hasten to add that "top-down" relates to a functional decomposition methodology, not to administrative hierarchy or to an assumption that records at the top created by the elite inherently carry more value. Corporate and governmental practices have long used such functional strategic thinking (as opposed to theoretical concepts), and it is evident today in business system analysis and system design in the world of computers, in current interest in business process reengineering and government restructuring, as well as increasingly in records management file classification and indexing and financial and human resource planning and measurement systems. And so, I thought back in 1989, why not also consider its applicability in archival appraisal? Macroappraisal, then, represents a congruence of theory and strategy.

The macroappraisal strategic approach has its greatest value precisely on this point. The reasoning behind the macroappraisal approach is simple enough to state. Institutions have certain formal or internally developed functions assigned or sanctioned by democratic societies; in this way, institutions are a filter for societal trends, activities, needs, and wishes, for the things and concepts that society values. For these assigned functions, the institutions articulate various subfunctions and sub-sub-functions, which are allocated to different administrative structures or offices, each with a mandate to perform or implement such a function, part of a function, or perhaps parts of several functions. These offices in turn create various programs and activities to meet their functional mandates, some continuing, some short term and temporary, which in turn lead to specific actions and individual transactions between the functional office and the citizen, organization, or group in society. For the efficient operation or delivery of these transactional interactions, information systems are built. Citizens, clients, groups, companies, and associations interact with these functions and structures, programs and activities, and, depending on the latitude and flexibility allowed for this interaction, in turn shape, challenge, and modify these programs to varying degrees. Of all these steps and processes, the record itself is the final evidence within those information systems of all these acts and transactions and of citizen/ societal interactions. This means that the contextual milieu in which records are created—what I have called their conceptual rather than their physical provenance—is determined by all these factors: functions, subfunctions, sub-subfunctions, structures, programs, activities, actions, transactions, and client interactions as well as records-creating processes, systems, and technologies. By focusing archival research on analyzing—that is, "appraising"—the importance of manageable numbers of these functions, programs, and activities rather than on appraising billions of records or tens of thousands of systems, series, and collections, the archivist can see the whole forest rather than just a few trees. Seeing the whole context ultimately means that poorer and duplicate records are more easily identified and eliminated and that the most succinct, precise, primary record in the best medium for a particular function is more readily targeted (or "appraised") for archival preservation. In short, macroappraisal strategy shifts the initial and major focus of appraisal from the record to the functional context in which the record is created.

Using such knowledge gained by an institutional functional analysis, the main appraisal questions for the archivist

are not what has been written (or drawn, photographed, filmed, or automated), where it is, and what research value does it has. Rather, based on this kind of functional-structural decomposition or analysis, the key appraisal questions are (1) what functions and activities of the creator should be documented (rather than what documentation should be kept?) and (2) who, in articulating and implementing the key functions, programs, and transactions of the institution, would have had cause to create a document, what type of document would it be, and with whom would that corporate person cooperate or interact in either its creation or its later use? These questions beg a third—really the most important—appraisal question: which records creators or "functions" (rather than which records) have the most importance? Conversely, and just as important from the total archives perspective, which functions are poorly documented in institutional records and must be complemented or supplemented by private manuscripts, other archival media, oral history projects, and nonarchival documentation (publications, "gray literature," buildings, inscriptions, monuments, museum and gallery artifacts, and so on), none of which are necessarily collected by archivists—or at least by institutional or corporate archivists. Only after these questions are answered can archivists target realistically the records or series of records likely to have greatest potential archival value.

After the macroappraisal is completed and the series or classes or systems or collections of records are before archivists for appraisal, traditional appraisal criteria can Page 177 → be applied where greater granularity is necessary or desirable. Such criteria are used to refine further the value of individual records or small groupings or series of records within the theoretical-strategic functional-structural matrix. Political, technical, legal, and preservation issues are also considered at this point. Known research uses may also be considered—at this final stage only, not driving the process. If the strategy is called macroappraisal, these record-related criteria constitute microappraisal. Such microappraisal criteria involve assessing such factors as age; uniqueness; aesthetic, intrinsic, or symbolic value; time span; authenticity; completeness; extent; manipulability; fragility; duplication; monetary value; and usefulness. Such appraisal criteria are certainly used now in the daily work of archivists and are well articulated in our literature; thus, no more need be said about them here.

Macroappraisal in Canada occurs at three levels: first, between all the various institutions or records creators or functions falling under the collection jurisdiction, mandate, or acquisition policy of an archives; second, between the various functional programs of a single institution or records creator; and, finally, between the various functions and activities of a single program or function within that creator—all using various criteria for assessing the importance of functions to institutions' mandates. For a macroappraisal strategy to work based on functional weighting, we found that a whole new relationship between the archives and government agencies was needed to implement what we termed a planned approach to records disposition. This established that records disposition must proceed in a logical manner, that records-creating agencies must be ranked and then approached in priority order, that formal negotiated disposition plans using project management methodology must be in place, and that each appraisal project must proceed comprehensively across a function, not in small administrative fragments, not medium by medium, not (at least at first) by looking at a few isolated examples of records in a few subregistries, and not (as is usual) in response to the latest space crisis in some part of the creating department. We also asked some hard questions about basic past assumptions regarding assigning or approving retention periods for nonarchival records and about focusing on passive records-destruction approvals rather than active archival targeting.[23]

Macroappraisal requires a firm commitment by the archives to research by its archivists and transparency to the future concerning its decision making. Choosing the best records requires extensive research by archivists—several months' worth for a large functional appraisal project. I will conclude by focusing on these two corollaries of macroappraisal—research and transparency—since the complexity of research by archivists is sometimes not well understood, thus making it easier to dismiss its importance when defining educational standards or employment competencies and since, given the "blindnesses" referred to previously, more transparency and accountability is evidently required so that we can see what we are doing and so that others can see and hold us to account. More germane to this volume, getting inside such research (even if by generalizations rather than concrete examples) reveals the degree to which archivists subjectively construct the past through appraisal.

To identify the small archival portion from the immense larger records universe, archivists undertake original research to discover the historical and contemporary functions and structures and key individuals that may be considered either representative of the whole or, conversely, special or outstanding in some way. Within governments, corporations, or the larger society, these functions, structures, and individuals are always changing and evolving over time and space, and archivists need through their research to identify and evaluate these changing trends. Archivists do this research in advance of general published historical knowledge because to produce such knowledge, historians depend in part on archivists' prior work. After appraisal and acquisition targets are developed based on this research, additional research into the history of the targeted individuals, groups, associations, communities, and institutions is required to determine which records in the most appropriate medium will best document that individual or institution's activities, including interaction with other individuals, groups, and institutions. Research into communication patterns and the nature and characteristics of recording media is required, as is research into organizational culture and information systems. New insights from organizational theory suggest that the functional-structural-transactional framework that underpins macroappraisal will need to be expanded to include new insights into how radically changing networked organizations work, including how formal memory products such as documents and records and filing and record-keeping systems interact with or exist sometimes entirely separate from informal but effective organizational memory strategies and learning systems and how these in turn are affected by different managerial styles, collaborative workplace discourses, and Page 178 → social networks that increasingly are recognized as animating organizational behavior.

This complex array of contextual factors of both traditional and new organizational theory will naturally influence the nature of the records being created and thus become factors that the archivist must research carefully to determine the significance or value of the records of a particular organization or creator or function or activity or citizen interaction.

The macroappraisal approach spends very little time researching and assessing historical themes or the latest trends in historiography and trying to match these to the kinds of records chosen (or appraised) as archival. That was the approach developed by archivists in the United States in the 1940s and copied pretty much worldwide when archivists perceived that the old Darwinian approach of taking custody passively of natural residues designated by administrators was untenable in an age of bureaucratic expansion and voluminous paper records. This was a major step forward from the older passive approach, attempting to perceive the trends and values important to society, if through the filter of academic historians, as the animating force in appraisal rather than leaving the selection of records to the processes and whims of their creator. But setting appraisal or memory values based on past, present, or anticipated historical research use patterns is fraught with conceptual and practical problems. This does not mean that macroappraisal should not be pragmatic or should result in records chosen not being useful. It does mean that archival appraisal, for all its subjectivity, requires a defendable intellectual framework rather than following the shifts of the academic marketplace “moved by the changing winds of historiography.”[24]

As a second corollary of macroappraisal, in addition to this extensive research into the records' context, these research results must be made transparent to the future. We archivists must remember the future. We must allow ourselves to be held accountable by revealing the research-based and personal suppositions on which keep/destroy decisions have been made. We must agree that we will be wrong in some appraisal decisions, that posterity needs to know why we left them the memory legacy that we did.

Perhaps our ghostly invisibility as archivists exists in part because our clients do not know what we do in terms of authorizing the widespread destruction of sources of possible use to them. Might archivists generally have been very lucky, except for our colleagues at the U.S. National Archives and Records Administration, in escaping close public and legal scrutiny of our appraisal decisions? Might that be because the transparency and accountability for which our profession increasingly calls among record creators is not something that we practice very well ourselves—in terms, for example, of making very widely known our appraisal choices, the reasons for them, and the research documentation supporting those choices? Do we even have well-articulated reasons for those choices? Why do we think researchers, especially in this postmodern environment, are interested only in

descriptions of the records already in our archives—our well-researched illuminations of the scope, content, and creator context of "our" records—but not in the reasons why we have those particular records and not others?

For government and institutional records, I propose that we place negative entries in our record group inventories, providing researchers with a description of all the series and collections in all media that we did *not* acquire from a particular record creator alongside the ones we did acquire and the appraisal reasons why decisions were made both to acquire and to not acquire. I think we should link all our series in descriptive inventories to the extensive, research-based appraisal reports, recognizing that some long-standing open-ended series may be acquired over several decades based on different appraisal decisions or reasoning by different archivists. More stark yet, I propose that appraising archivists should be documented with a vita on file, complemented by biographical and autobiographical details of their values used in appraisal. For private-sector or thematic archives, I think we should provide the equivalent evidence of our choices—perhaps lists of all the possible individuals, groups, and associations falling within the collecting mandate of our institution, as researched and considered by the archivists, contrasted with the much smaller list of those collections or fonds appraised as archival and acquired—and explanations of why those choices were made, using what criteria, based on what concepts of value or significance, employing what methodologies, by which archivists, reflecting what personal and professional values.

Because we do not generally make such information on our thought processes available, assuming that we even have articulated them to our own satisfaction, researchers see only a predefined universe—predefined by the archivist, among others. What they see is what they get. They do not see what we saw as archivists before the appraisal decisions were made to give them what they get. This perhaps explains why archives, unlike galleries and museums, have generally escaped the culture wars and Page 179 → why our construction of societal memory via appraisal—and subsequent archival actions—so far remains unchallenged, even (as I suggested earlier) ignored. Is what we archivists do so unimportant? Or is it invisible, unknown, inarticulate? Do we shun the challenge of public scrutiny? And if so, why? The ghosts of archives apparently still haunt us. There needs, in short, to be a better integration of the archivist (the subject) with the records (the object) in memory narratives.

Can this Canadian archival distinctiveness contribute internationally in the twenty-first century? Is there a future for the postmodern archive? I believe the quick answer is yes, and on several levels. If there are benefits of the Canadian way of diversity, ambiguity, tolerance, and multiple identities in John Ralston Saul's postmodern state, then the Canadian parallel way of remembering via macroappraisal, of approaching the creation and preservation of memory in archives, might well speak strongly to the world's citizens concerned in this new century about the homogenizing and globalizing bias of the new media and record-creating technologies. Those desiring to construct archival memory based on celebrating difference rather than monoliths, multiple rather than mainstream narratives, the personal and local as much as the corporate and official, may find in Canada's distinctive approach to appraising archives some useful perspectives and tools for their task.

Steven Lubar, a specialist in the culture of information technology for the Smithsonian National Museum of American History, reminds us that "we must think of archives as active, not passive, as sites of power, not as recorders of power. Archives don't simply record the work of culture; they do the work of culture."[25] Words such as *culture* and *power* are not neutral, but then, neither are Doughty's descriptions of archives as "precious assets" or the greatest gift across generations of our "civilization." What kind of gift to "civilization" or "culture" does this generation of archivists wish to make? How do archivists want the future to remember them as they construct a past for that future? The answers rest with how we conceive of, set strategies for, develop criteria concerning, implement in practice, and then document our decisions in archival appraisal.

NOTES

The heart of this essay was a paper presented at the Sawyer Seminars. Portions of the text have appeared elsewhere; other portions appear here for the first time.

1. On the invisible or marginalized role of women in the historical enterprise and implicitly in the archival

one, see Bonnie Smith, *The Gender of History: Men, Women, and Historical Practice* (Cambridge and London, 1998). See also Gerda Lerner, *The Creation of Feminist Consciousness: From the Middle Ages to Eighteen-Seventy* (New York and Oxford, 1993), esp. chap. 11, "The Search for Women's History"; Anke Voss-Hubbard, "'No Documents—No History': Mary Ritter Beard and the Early History of Women's Archives," *American Archivist* 58 (winter 1995): 16–30.

2. Tom Nesmith, "Still Fuzzy, but More Accurate: Some Thoughts on the 'Ghosts' of Archival Theory," *Archivaria* 47 (spring 1999): 150 n. 18.

3. Patrick J. Geary, *Phantoms of Remembrance: Memory and Oblivion at the End of the First Millennium* (Princeton, 1994). Michael Kammen refers to the *Mystic Chords of Memory* as the main title of his book on the creation of American tradition, memory, and a usable past (New York, 1991).

4. Nesmith, "Still Fuzzy," 149.

5. Brien Brothman, "The Limits of Limits: Derridean Deconstruction and the Archival Institution," *Archivaria* 36 (autumn 1993): 205–20.

6. Peter Novick, *That Noble Dream: The "Objectivity Question" and the American Historical Profession* (Cambridge, U.K., 1988).

7. Joy Parr, "Gender, History and Historical Practice," *Canadian Historical Review* 76 (September 1995): 354–76.

8. Arthur Doughty, *The Canadian Archives and Its Activities* (Ottawa, 1924), 5.

9. Jean-Pierre Wallot, "Building a Living Memory for the History of Our Present: Perspectives on Archival Appraisal," *Journal of the Canadian Historical Association* 2 (1991): 282.

10. Pierre Nora, as cited in John R. Gillis, introduction to *Commemorations: The Politics of National Identity*, ed. Gillis (Princeton, 1994), 15.

11. See Harold A. Innis, *The Bias of Communication* (Toronto, 1951); Harold A. Innis, *Empire and Communications* (Oxford, 1950). For interesting commentaries about McLuhan in terms of memory and communications, see Patrick H. Hutton, *History as an Art of Memory* (Hanover, Vt., 1993), 13–17; Paul Levinson, *Digital McLuhan: A Guide to the Information Millennium* (London, 1999). For a new assessment of Innis in light of postmodern sensibilities, see Charles R. Acland and William J. Buxton, eds., *Harold Innis in the New Century: Reflections and Refractions* (Montreal and Kingston, 2000).

12. See Terry Cook, "What Is Past Is Prologue: A History of Archival Ideas since 1898, and the Future Paradigm Shift" *Archivaria* 43 (spring 1997): 17–63. At the risk of facing charges of self-promotion, I believe this may be the best place to start for nonarchivists wishing to explore the history and evolution of archival thinking generally in the English-speaking world and in particular for Canada, and the assertions of the following paragraphs are documented in this article as well.

13. Sir Hilary Jenkinson flourished in Britain's Public Record office during the first half of the twentieth century and wrote the first major English-language text of archival theory and practice, *A Manual of Archive Administration* (London, 1922; rev. 2d ed. 1937; reprint 1968). For a discussion and citations, see Cook, "What Is Past," 23–26.

Page 180 → 14. This paragraph reflects my central argument in "What Is Past." See also Eric Ketelaar, "Archives of the People, by the People, for the People," *South Africa Archives Journal* 34 (1992): 15–26, reprinted in Eric Ketelaar, *The Archival Image: Collected Essays* (Hilversum, 1997). For a new volume of case studies of the critical role of records and archives in underpinning public accountability in democracies, see Richard J. Cox and David A. Wallace, *Archives and the Public Good: Accountability and Records in Modern Society* (Westport, Conn., and London, 2002).

15. See Ian E. Wilson, "Reflections on *Archival Strategies*," *American Archivist* 58 (fall 1995): 414–28. For archivists merely (and meekly) to do what they think their government sponsors want regarding institutional records or what archivists think will please these sponsors and thus show that archivists are good corporate players worthy of continued funding is, as Shirley Spragge says, too easy (and too irresponsible) an abdication of archivists' cultural mission and societal responsibilities. See her "The Abdication Crisis: Are Archivists Giving up Their Cultural Responsibility?" *Archivaria* 40 (fall 1995): 173–81.

16. For more detail on the postmodern turn within archives and the archival profession, see, in addition to Cook, "What Is Past," two complementary articles, Terry Cook, "Archival Science and Postmodernism: New Formulations for Old Concepts," *Archival Science: International Journal on Recorded Information* 1.1 (2001): 3–24; Terry Cook, "Fashionable Nonsense or Professional Rebirth: Postmodernism and the Practice

of Archives," *Archivaria* 51 (spring 2001): 14–35, which provides more detailed support for the generalizations that follow.

17. For an extensive list of relevant Canadian and other citations, current to the summer of 2001, see Cook, "Fashionable Nonsense," 20 n. 14. A very important (and non-Canadian) addition is Carolyn Hamilton, Verne Harris, et al., *Refiguring the Archive* (Cape Town, 2002).

18. See Jacques Le Goff, *History and Memory*, trans. Steven Rendall and Elizabeth Claman (New York, 1992), esp. xvi–xvii, 59–60. Feminist scholars are keenly aware of the ways that systems of language, writing, and information recording and the preserving of such information once recorded are social and power based, not neutral, both now and across past millennia. See, for example, Gerda Lerner, *The Creation of Patriarchy* (New York and Oxford, 1986), esp. 6–7, 57, 151, 200; Riane Eisler, *The Chalice and The Blade* (San Francisco, 1987), 71–73, 91–93. Lerner's more recent study, *Creation of Feminist Consciousness*, details the systemic exclusion of women from history and archives and women's attempts starting in the late nineteenth century to correct this by creating women's archives; see esp. chap. 11, "The Search for Women's History." On the Paris mobs, see Janice Panitch, "Liberty, Equality, Posterity? Some Archival Lessons from the Case of the French Revolution," *American Archivist* 59 (winter 1996): 30–47. For other examples and citations, see Cook, "What Is Past," 18, 50. We have the sad case in our own time of the deliberate records destruction in Kosovo and Bosnia to efface memory and marginalize peoples or to hide illegal or embarrassing behavior, as in Watergate and the Enron scandal, among others. See again many of the studies in Cox and Wallace, *Archives and the Public Good.*

19. Taylor was a three-time provincial archivist and influential director in the 1970s at the National Archives of Canada. For but five examples of his important articles bringing McLuhan and contemporary social and cultural theory to bear on archival perspectives, see Hugh Taylor, "The Media of the Record: Archives in the Wake of McLuhan," *Georgia Archive* 6 (spring 1978): 1–10; Hugh Taylor, "Information Ecology and the Archives of the 1980s," *Archivaria* 18 (summer 1984): 25–37; Hugh Taylor, "Transformation in the Archives: Technological Adjustment or Paradigm Shift?" *Archivaria* 25 (winter 1987–88): 12–28; Hugh Taylor, "My Very Act and Deed: Some Reflections on the Role of Textual Records in the Conduct of Affairs," *American Archivist* 41 (fall 1988): 456–69; Hugh Taylor, "Opening Address," in *Documents That Move and Speak: Audiovisual Archives in the New Information Age: Proceedings of a Symposium Organized for the International Council of Archives by the National Archives of Canada* (Munich, 1992). For aspects of Taylor's major impact, see Tom Nesmith, "Hugh Taylor's Contextual Idea for Archives and the Foundation of Graduate Education in Archival Studies," in *The Archival Imagination: Essays in Honour of Hugh A. Taylor*, ed. Barbara Craig (Ottawa, 1992), as well as many of the essays by Taylor's disciples and admirers in this Festschrift in his honor. The volume also contains a bibliography of his work to that date. An annotated collection of his best archival essays is forthcoming: see Terry Cook and Gordon Dodds, eds., *Imagining Archives: Essays and Reflections by Hugh A. Taylor* (Lanham, MD, 2003).

20. For detailed analysis of its historical evolution and future prospects, see Laura Millar, "Discharging Our Debt: The Evolution of the Total Archives Concept in English Canada," *Archivaria* 46 (fall 1998): 103–46; Laura Millar, "The Spirit of Total Archives: Seeking a Sustainable Archival System," *Archivaria* 47 (spring 1999): 46–65. For a critical overview, see Terry Cook, "The Tyranny of the Medium: A Comment on Total Archives," *Archivaria* 9 (winter 1979–80): 141–49; Terry Cook, "Media Myopia," *Archivaria* 12 (summer 1981): 146–57.

21. John Ralston Saul, "The Inclusive Shape of Complexity," keynote address presented at the International Conference on Canadian Studies, "The Canadian Distinctiveness into the Twenty-first Century," University of Ottawa, 18 May 2000, published in *The Canadian Distinctiveness into the XXIst Century*, ed. Chad Gaffield and Karen L. Gould (Ottawa, 2003), 13–27. See also John Ralston Saul, *The Unconscious Civilization* (Concord, Ont., 1995).

22. The initial texts on macroappraisal are Terry Cook, *The Archival Appraisal of Records Containing Personal Information: A RAMP Study with Guidelines* (Paris, 1991); Terry Cook, "'Many Are Called but Few Are Chosen': Appraisal Guidelines for Sampling and Selecting Case Files," *Archivaria* 32 (summer 1991): 25–50; Terry Cook, "Mind over Matter: Towards a New Theory of Archival Appraisal," in *Archival Imagination*, ed. Craig. Other important conceptual analyses are Richard Brown, "Macro-Appraisal Theory and the Context of the Public Records Creator," *Archivaria* 40 (fall 1995): 121–72; Richard Brown, "Records Acquisition Strategy and Its Theoretical Foundation: The Case for a Concept of Archival

Hermeneutics," *Archivaria* 33 (winter 1991–92): 34–56; Richard Brown, Page 181 → "The Value of 'Narrativity' in the Appraisal of Historical Documents: Foundation for a Theory of Archival Hermeneutics," *Archivaria* 32 (summer 1991): 152–56; Terry Cook, "Macroappraisal and Functional Analysis: Appraisal Theory, Strategy, and Methodology for Archivists," in *L'evaluation des archives: Des necessites de la gestion aux exigences du temoignage*, Groupe Interdisciplinaire de Recherche en Archivistique, 3d symposium (Montreal, 1998). For its historical context, see Cook, "What Is Past." Both Cook and Brown drew inspiration from Hans Booms, "Society and the Formation of a Documentary Heritage: Issues in the Appraisal of Archival Sources," trans. Hermina Joldersma and Richard Klumpenhouwer, *Archivaria* 24 (summer 1987): 69–107; originally published 1972; and from the structuration theory of British sociologist Anthony Giddens. Several published case studies of implementing macroappraisal are Jim Suderman, "Appraising Records of the Expenditure Management Function: An Exercise in Functional Analysis," *Archivaria* 43 (spring 1997): 129–42; Catherine Bailey, "From the Top Down: The Practice of Macro-Appraisal," *Archivaria* 43 (spring 1997): 89–128; Candace Loewen, "From Human Neglect to Planetary Survival: New Approaches to the Appraisal of Environmental Records," *Archivaria* 33 (winter 1991–92): 87–103; Jean-Stephen Piche and Sheila Powell, "Counting Archives In: The Appraisal of the 1991 Census of Canada," *Archivaria* 45 (spring 1998): 27–43; Jean-Stephen Piche,"Macro-Appraisal and Duplication of Information: Federal Real Property Management Records," *Archivaria* 39 (spring 1995): 39–50; Ellen Scheinberg, "Case File Theory: Does It Work in Practice?," *Archivaria* 38 (fall 1994): 45–60.

23. For the strategic "disposition" as opposed to the appraisal side of the macroappraisal approach, see, in addition to the sources in n. 22, Eldon Frost, "A Weak Link in the Chain: Records Scheduling as a Source of Archival Acquisition," *Archivaria* 33 (winter 1991–92): 78–86; Bruce Wilson, "Systematic Appraisal of the Records of the Government of Canada at the National Archives of Canada," *Archivaria* 38 (fall 1994): 218–31.

24. F. Gerald Ham, "The Archival Edge," in *A Modern Archives Reader: Basic Readings on Archival Theory and Practice*, ed. Maygene F. Daniels and Timothy Walch (Washington, D.C., 1984), 328–29. Appraisal by use is most closely identified with American appraisal theory as pioneered principally by T. R. Schellenberg and his colleagues from the 1940s onward. Schellenberg's fullest statement of his oft-cited principles appears in "The Appraisal of Modern Public Records," *National Archives Bulletin* 8 (1956), an extract of which is more readily available in Daniels and Walch, *Modern Archives Reader*, 57–70. The Society of American Archivists also sanctioned this approach: see Maynard J. Brichford, *Archives and Manuscripts: Appraisal and Accessioning* (Chicago, 1977). Schellenberg's inbuence remains strong; a recent textbook chapter asserted that his secondary values relating to "research uses" remain "the principal concern of archivists" in appraising records (Maygene F. Daniels, "Records Appraisal and Disposition," in *Managing Archives and Archival Institutions*, ed. James Gregory Bradsher [Chicago, 1988], 60).

25. Steven Lubar, "Information Culture and the Archival Record," *American Archivist* 62 (spring 1999): 15.